

Berhan Voss

Alchemicalist of the First Order
Personal Journal

Bench journal

Berhan Voss. Alchemicalist of the First Order.

The old book has stuck together along the bottom, so I'm copying the recipes while I can still read them. This one can live on the shelf when the vat is open. I keep putting books beside me because it's convenient, and then acting surprised when something splashes on them.

I built the bench too low. It seemed sensible when I measured the room, but after a full day over the vat I can barely straighten up. Raising it means moving everything off it, so I keep leaving the job until I have a quiet day. Xhal'theris has just asked for another order by tomorrow, which takes care of that.

He took me off a trade road and put me to work here, and somehow I'm the one who owes him something. The last time I refused a batch, he brought someone down to test the unfinished stuff on. I made it properly. I've kept making it properly since. He lets me trade what's left after his orders, and that pays for my food, supplies, and whatever I can put aside.

There's a drip above the bed again. I moved it, then had to shift the cupboard to get the door open. I miss having a room where I can change something without moving everything else. I miss the window in the shop, too. Used to complain about the draught through the shutters, but at least I knew when it was evening.

Read same line again. Lost it.

Later

Hand too big for pen. Hold with whole hand.

Hair gone. On floor. Skin hurt where clothes was. Cut clothes off.

Need fix vat. Need work. No work no coin.

Green down there. Get green out. Fix it.

Can't read small words.

Later

hurt bad

no sleep

green in vat. mine

need green

go find powder

Berhan. name Berhan.

Morning

Itching everywhere. Woke up scratching my chest. Shirt tight across the shoulders. Thought I'd slept twisted in it, but the seams are pulling when I stand still.

Can't keep my place reading yesterday's notes. Writing this down while I can. Need to know when it started.

The potion. I hadn't touched the vat. This started after I drank it.

Skin looks gray up both arms now. Not just the old marks on my fingers. Hair came out when I scratched my head. More on the pillow.

Tried to put my coat on. Can't get both arms into it. My hands are swollen. No, not swollen. Bigger. Fingers longer. Can't get the ring off.

Broke the chair sitting down. Weighed myself on the stock platform. More than twice what I was. Checked the weights. Twice. This is not swelling.

My back won't stop hurting. Jaw hurts when I shut my mouth. Teeth don't meet right.

By the gods, the pain. My legs. Can't sit. Can't stand without it starting again.

Need the other potion. Need the right powder. I know the recipe. It's in here.

I need new spectacles before the cracked lens gets any worse. I'll get a price next time I'm out. If I can read without a headache, I might make fewer mistakes copying this book.

Potion of Acid Resistance

The vat needs cleaning before I can start the next order, so I'm making an acid resistance draught first. It gives resistance to acid damage for 1 hour, which is enough for the cleaning if I have everything ready. It doesn't mean I can leave my hand in there while I look for a cloth.

I've nearly run out of Black Dragon Scale Powder. I'll have to buy more on the next trip, but there's enough left for this batch if I measure it properly.

Ingredients

2 pinches Powdered Pearl

1 spoonful Black Dragon Scale Powder

3 drops Wyvern Venom

1 spoonful Troll Blood

1 pinch Blessed Hart Antler Powder

1 measure Moonwater

I still feel hot and my arms ache. I couldn't face the bread. I'll sleep, sort out the antler powder tomorrow, and make another batch. I need the crystal out and the vat working before I'm selling the last of the furniture.

First attempt

I used the small silver cauldron and kept everything well away from the vat. I measured the whole batch before starting, then checked each step against the invulnerability recipe as I went. The Ironvine Thread pulled taut and the rest went in in the right order, but there was grit left after the antler powder. I stirred longer instead of stopping to examine it.

Once the dose was ready, I secured the rope, cleared a place for the lid, and put the receiving bowl within reach. I drank the potion before opening the vat.

I knew something was wrong straight away. It was bitter enough to make my jaw ache, then I felt heat through my mouth and down my arms. My fingers wouldn't hold the rope properly. I sat down before I fell and waited until I could stand again. I hadn't touched the vat.

I went back to the antler packet, crushed the gritty bits with the spoon, and compared them with the little left in my old jar. They aren't the same. I don't know what the goblins have mixed into this, but it isn't the Blessed Hart Antler Powder I paid for. They lied to me, and I let the price convince me it must be good.

I've checked the remaining supplies separately. The scale powder, gland, pearl, and thread are good, as is my own stock. There's enough for another batch once I replace that one ingredient. I've marked the bad packet and put it apart from everything else so I don't reach for it by mistake.

Method

- 1. Pour the clear, rain-scented Moonwater into the silver cauldron. Shake until the blue-white sparks vanish.*
- 2. Stir in the Powdered Pearl until silver ribbons circle the bottom.*

I once tried Glassroot Sap here when I was short of pearl. It forms a skin in the healing draught, so I thought it might do the same job. The skin broke apart as soon as I added the scale powder. Powdered Pearl keeps the mixture together through that stage. Buying it costs less than throwing away another batch, however much I resent the price.

- 3. Add the Black Dragon Scale Powder with the iron stirring rod.*
- 4. Add the Troll Blood. Keep stirring until the surface stops pitting the rod.*
- 5. Mix in the Wyvern Venom, then dust in the Blessed Hart Antler Powder.*
- 6. Cool in the bowl before bottling.*

A successful batch turns pearl-gray, with a thin shell climbing the bottle walls. The vinegar smell takes a while to fade. I cleaned the vat after bottling and lost most of the afternoon to it, but the next batch came out properly. There's no point saving an hour on cleaning if I can't sell what comes out afterward.

I'm also nearly out of the pale polishing grit from the old Dwarven Forge. It collects in the stone seams behind the quenching troughs and cleans the scale pans without scratching them. I haven't found it anywhere else down here. There were thick webs across the lower doorway when I went for another sack, so I left it where it was. I'll ask the goblins whether they've been in recently.

The trader's name is Flaxese. He keeps his stall in a den just north of the way out to the Drift Stones. He is fairer than most of his kind, which is not saying much, and he is still as greedy as any goblin with both hands free.

There are two ways to reach him that I know. One is through a hidden door at the far north-east of the Main Hall, past bodies that are best left undisturbed. The other is a trap door above his patch, reached straight off the Drift Stone room. I've also noticed a secret door near him that only seems to hold shut when the old hoard beside it is stacked in place. When the hoard has been moved, the door stands open like a broken cupboard.

I've drawn the map below in case anything ever happens to me in this cursed place.

With my own stock, I've got enough for two attempts. That was worth paying for; a single bad batch can't leave me without another way into the vat. The antler powder looks coarser than the last lot, but the trader said that's how this batch was ground. He charged for the blessing separately and wouldn't come down on it.

If this works, I can take ordinary orders again tomorrow. The spectacles and the coat will have to wait until I've paid back what this has cost me.

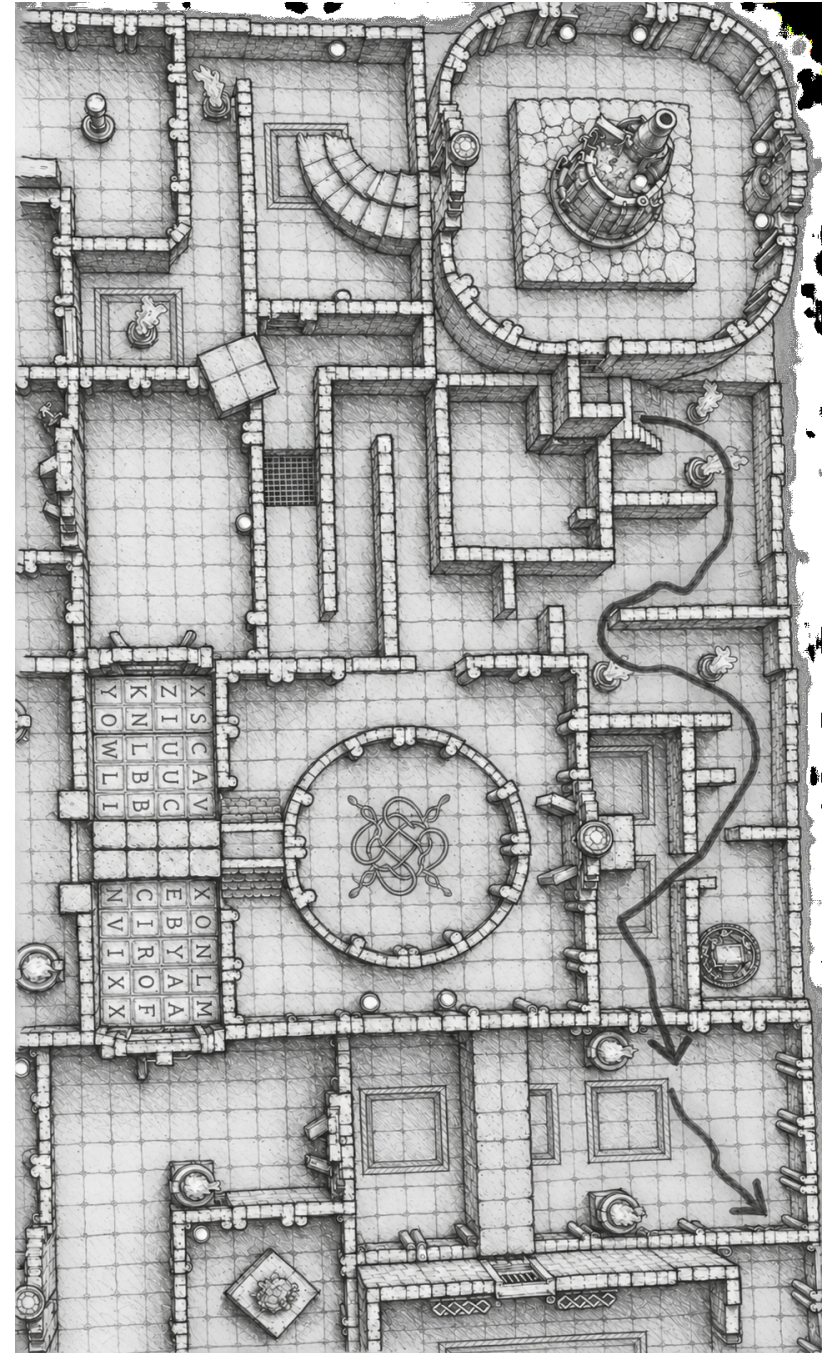
Back from the goblins

I was gone most of the day. The stall had some of what I needed, and the trader sent someone back for the rest. I shouldn't have told him the vat was out of use. As soon as he knew I couldn't work without these supplies, he stopped bargaining.

I got proper Black Dragon Scale Powder, good Fire Beetle Gland, fine Powdered Pearl, and Ironvine Thread without the brittle ends. He also had a small packet he swore was Blessed Hart Antler Powder prepared for the stronger work. He kept reminding me how rare these supplies are. I know they're rare. I also know what he charged before he knew I was stuck.

It cost nearly everything in the purse, four finished bottles, and the spare brass scales. He wanted the good set as well. I had to explain twice that I couldn't make the potion reliably without them, which would leave me unable to make anything else to sell him.

The porter helped wrap the jars for the crossing and asked why I looked so tired. I nearly told him the whole business. After what it had already cost me, I decided not to tell anyone else how desperate I'd become. I bought bread before handing over the last of the coin, so at least there's something to eat when the work is done.



Potion of Fire Resistance

Sold the last two bottles this morning, so I need to replace them before Xhal'theris takes the rest for his trials. This gives resistance to fire damage for 1 hour. It sells well enough that I might finally be able to replace the cracked cooling bowl.

There's only one dram left in the gland jar. I've put that on the order for three bottles, although I expect someone will bring the order back and ask why I've only made one.

Ingredients

1 dram Fire Beetle Gland

1 pinch Charcoal of Salamander Bone

3 drops Honey of the Sun Bee

1 measure Cinder Reed

1 sprig Kingsfoil

1 pinch Frostsalt

I took a little out in the testing dish, but nothing I tried made it fit to work with again. I'm spending supplies on spoiled liquid while the orders sit unfinished. It's been two days without a sale, and I can't replace the tools I'm ruining until I get the vat working. Nearly every coin I spend starts with a batch in there.

An acid resistance draught won't be enough for this. I'll have to make invulnerability and get the crystal out while the dose lasts. That gives me one minute of protection, and it will still hurt. There's enough left in the purse for a supply trip, though I doubt it will cover what the goblins ask.

Vat trouble

Dropped the Green Transmutation Crystal into the vat this morning. It was in my inside coat pocket, and when I leaned over to scrape the far side it slipped out. I heard it hit the rim and saw it go under before I could catch it.

The mixture started boiling without any more heat. It splashed my wrist as I reached for the lid, so I washed it straight off and used some of the healing draught. The wrist is still sore, but I can use the hand.

I tried the long iron tongs next. The ends came back shorter. This batch wasn't anything like that before the crystal went in; now it eats whatever I lower into it. I can still see green light at the bottom, so at least it hasn't eaten the crystal.

I can't use the vat or bottle what's in it, which leaves all this afternoon's work waiting on the bench. I need to get the crystal out before I can drain the spoiled mixture and start again. I've put the lid back on while I work out how to do it.

Next morning

Tried a hook on a longer rod and lost the hook. Then I tried scooping from the shallow side and ruined the scoop. I'm not putting my hand in after seeing what happened to the metal.

Method

- 1. Warm the Cinder Reed over the burner until it exhales one ember.*
- 2. Add the Fire Beetle Gland while the ember is visible.*
- 3. Crush the Kingsfoil and stir it in with the glass stirring rod.*
- 4. Add the Charcoal of Salamander Bone. The red flecks should brighten near the flame.*
- 5. Drip in the Honey of the Sun Bee only after the mixture stops smoking.*
- 6. Finish with the Frostsalt.*

When the mixture is right, a small sun flares beneath the cauldron, then folds into a calm red glow. The bottle should warm the hand without burning it. A white flash followed by bitter smoke and cold gritty sludge means the batch has gone wrong. Don't bottle it just because the glass is already laid out.

Asked about the forge when I went to price the cooling bowl. Spiders have infested the place, and even the goblins won't go there anymore. One of the porters showed me where a bite had gone through his boot. His foot was still swollen. I offered to pay for a sack of the polishing grit, but he wouldn't discuss it.

I can't get that material anywhere else, which leaves me saving the last of it for the scales. The other tools will have to stay stained. I'd rather put up with that than end up unable to walk back to the lab.

Potion of Poison Resistance

Grovlikk's old room has made poison resistance worth keeping in stock. I still haven't got the smell out of the coat I wore in there, and I'm tired of being asked about it at the stall. This gives resistance to poison damage for 1 hour. It won't do anything for the coat.

I need a better lamp before I make a large batch. The moss takes too long to contract under the cracked one, and holding the bowl closer to the light leaves me a hand short for everything else.

Ingredients

2 pinches Nightshade Berries

1 measure Moonwater

1 tuft Grave Moss

1 sprig Kingsfoil

1 pinch Powdered Pearl

1 pod Silted Star Anise

1 pinch Blessed Hart Antler Powder

There's still no collecting at the old Dwarven Forge. The spiders haven't gone, and the goblins have stopped sending anyone in. I've put the last of the polishing grit aside for the scales because I can't replace it from anywhere else. I can work with stained tools as long as I can trust my measurements.

Sales have been decent this week. Once I've paid for supplies, I should have something left toward the spectacles. The coat can wait a little longer if I repair the inside pocket. It's come loose at the top, and I keep forgetting until I put something in it.

Stock and routes

The Kingsfoil was dry again. I told the seller I wanted fresh-cut, and he said it was fresh when he cut it. I'll take the old bundle back so we can stop arguing about what I meant and look at what he sold me.

I also need Blessed Hart Antler Powder soon. There's a little ordinary stock left, but none of the properly prepared grade I'd use for invulnerability. The Black Dragon Scale Powder is low as well, so this won't be a cheap trip.

I used to lose a week going into goblin territory for supplies. The stall near the Drift Stones cuts that to a day there and back, provided the crossing behaves. I don't like the wild magic, but the other route takes me past the Lava Elementals. At least I've come back from the Drift Stones enough times to know I can do it.

I'll take coin and finished bottles, and return the jars the trader lent me. He doesn't make much fuss about lending them, but he counts every stopper. I can't complain about that when I do the same thing. I will ask what the supplies cost before I tell him how business has been. Last time I mentioned a good week, the price of the next packet went up.

Method

1. Put the Grave Moss in the cooling bowl. Expose it to the brightest light available. Wait for it to contract.
2. Add the Moonwater after the fibers contract.
3. Crush the Nightshade Berries until the purple stain appears. Stir them in.
4. Add the Kingsfoil and let the surface settle.
5. Dust in the Powdered Pearl.
6. Add the Silted Star Anise. Wait for it to point toward the nearest metal.
7. Add the Blessed Hart Antler Powder last.

Purple vapor should curl up and catch in the moss, leaving a clear green drink with a fresh herbal smell. Keep the moss out of the good cloths afterward. I've washed one twice and it still smells like the jar, so that's another cloth fit only for cleaning the floor.

The damp doesn't help. Nothing dries properly in this room unless I hang it near the burner, and then I have to keep moving it out of the way. I used to dry the shop cloths over the yard wall. Never thought I'd miss doing the washing.

Lesser Healing Potion

Sold my last healing draught yesterday, then cut my thumb cleaning the glass an hour later. I'm making another batch and keeping a bottle beside the burner, even if somebody offers good coin for it. These restore $2d4 + 2$ hit points, which would have been quite enough for the thumb.

The Glassroot Sap must go in after the syrup. I got that wrong once and had to chip the result off the spoon. The bent spoon beside the jar is for scraping, by the way. I keep picking it up to measure with because I haven't put it somewhere else.

Ingredients

- 1 spoonful Troll Blood
- 3 drops Honey of the Sun Bee
- 1 measure Moonwater
- 1 sprig Kingsfoil
- 1 pinch Blessed Hart Antler Powder
- 1 tuft Grave Moss
- 1 pinch Glassroot Sap

Method

1. Shake the Moonwater until its sparks move in a fast ring.
2. Tap the Thunderhead Lichen to release one snap of static into that ring.
3. Add the Fire Beetle Gland and the Charcoal of Salamander Bone. The red flecks should answer the flame.
4. Stir in the Troll Blood until it closes over the rod.
5. Add the Wyvern Venom in two drops.
6. Drip in the Honey of the Sun Bee.
7. Crush the Kingsfoil over the cauldron and stir once.

A sharp crack runs through the bottle when it's right. The liquid flashes bronze and nearby metal tools point toward it for a moment. I had to move the knife before it knocked into a bottle.

His order is finished now, so I can get back to the work that pays for my supplies. I don't know what he does with all of it, and asking hasn't helped. I do know what happens if I refuse to make it. For now I'm going to clean the bench and see whether there's enough food left to last until the next trip.

Potion of Battle Prowess

Another order from Xhal'theris, this time for a potion that gives a +2 bonus to attack rolls and damage rolls for 1 minute. I have to take the ingredients from the same stock I use for my paying work, so I'll need a decent week at the stall to make up for it.

I'm tired and nearly measured three drops of Wyvern Venom out of habit. This one takes two. I put the spoon down and checked the page before I went any further. I should eat before finishing the batch.

Ingredients

- 1 dram Fire Beetle Gland
- 1 pinch Charcoal of Salamander Bone
- 2 drops Wyvern Venom
- 1 spoonful Troll Blood
- 1 measure Moonwater
- 3 drops Honey of the Sun Bee
- 1 sprig Kingsfoil
- 1 pinch Thunderhead Lichen

Method

1. Warm the Moonwater until its sparks rise to the surface.
2. Stir in the Troll Blood until every groove it makes closes.
3. Add the Grave Moss and wait for it to contract.
4. Crush the Kingsfoil into the cauldron.
5. Add the Honey of the Sun Bee in three slow drops.
6. Stretch a thread of Glassroot Sap over the surface and stir it through.
7. Dust in the Blessed Hart Antler Powder. Bottle while warm.

The finished liquid is red, with a steady pulse and fine glassy threads across the surface. It smells of warm honey and mint. I've marked the bottle by the burner so I don't accidentally pack it with the ones for sale.

One of the goblin porters came by with a cut across his palm. He'd caught it unloading a crate, so I cleaned it and gave him a little of the draught. He came back later with lamp oil and two onions. I hadn't asked for payment, but I was glad of both.

It reminded me to buy food on the next trip. I keep going to the stall with a list of reagents and coming home with nothing for supper. The onions went into soup, which was better than eating another piece of hard bread over the sink.

Greater Healing Potion

This restores 4d4 + 4 hit points, but it costs considerably more to make than the lesser draught. Customers usually ask for the stronger bottle until they hear the price. I've started asking what they actually need it for before I take it off the shelf.

I'm making enough to put two bottles aside for the next supply trip. The goblins will take finished work when they won't take anything else, and I would rather trade that than another tool.

Ingredients

2 spoonfuls Troll Blood

1 dram Fire Beetle Gland

3 drops Honey of the Sun Bee

1 measure Moonwater

1 pinch Blessed Hart Antler Powder

1 pinch Nightshade Berries

1 sprig Kingsfoil

Method

1. Pour Moonwater into the cauldron. Shake until the sparks form a ring.

2. Stir in Powdered Pearl until silver ribbons make a continuous shell.

3. Add Black Dragon Scale Powder with the iron rod. Wait until the ring stops stinging the metal.

4. Lower in Ironvine Thread. Stir until it pulls taut.

5. Add Fire Beetle Gland.

6. Fold in Troll Blood in two spoonfuls.

7. Drip in Honey of the Sun Bee.

8. Dust in Blessed Hart Antler Powder.

Check every jar before starting. I can afford to throw away a mistake with a cheap healing draught. With this one I'd be selling tools to replace it, and the goblins already ask after my good scales every time I visit.

A minute should be enough to reach into the vat and pull something out, provided everything is ready. I'd want the rope secured, the receiving bowl close, and a clear place to put the lid before drinking. It's easy to forget how long those little jobs take when I'm doing them one-handed.

Potion of Invulnerability

I've copied this from the old notes because the bottom of that page has begun to come apart. For 1 minute after drinking, the drinker has resistance to all damage. They can still be hurt, and they have to finish whatever they're doing before that minute is up.

It's a very rare potion and expensive enough that I don't keep a finished bottle. The grades of ingredients needed cost more than most of my ordinary stock. If somebody orders one, I'll ask for enough coin up front to cover the supplies. I can't afford to make it and then have them change their mind.

Ingredients

2 spoonfuls Troll Blood

1 spoonful Black Dragon Scale Powder

1 dram Fire Beetle Gland

2 pinches Powdered Pearl

1 measure Moonwater

1 pinch Blessed Hart Antler Powder

3 drops Honey of the Sun Bee

1 pinch Ironvine Thread

Method

1. Crush the Nightshade Berries in the mortar until the purple stain is even.

I understand why people question the Nightshade Berries in a healing draught. I questioned them myself. I tried more Honey of the Sun Bee instead, hoping to avoid the bitter catalyst, but it didn't prepare the mixture for the Troll Blood. It was sweeter and useless. I'll explain that if someone asks, though I won't be giving them a sample of the failed version.

2. Pour in the Moonwater. Stir until its sparks move in a single ring.

3. Add the Fire Beetle Gland and wait for the ring to brighten.

4. Fold in the Troll Blood in two portions.

5. Add the Kingsfoil.

6. Drip in the Honey of the Sun Bee only when the brew smells clean and sharp.

7. Dust in the Blessed Hart Antler Powder.

The batch came out well. My left fingertips are still gray, but they've been like that for years. These draughts close a fresh cut well enough; they haven't done much for the damage I've worked into my hands. Wearing the gloves would probably do more good than drinking another bottle.

The trader tried to count the glass as part of the payment again. I charge for the contents, and he knows it. If he wants to keep the bottle, he can return an empty one or pay for it. We have this discussion most visits, although he somehow remembers exactly which jars I've borrowed from him.

He asked after my hand once we'd finished arguing and gave me a cup of something hot from the stove. It was too salty, but I stayed and drank it. I hadn't sat and talked to anyone for a while without having to keep one eye on a batch.

Purple stone

I keep thinking about the caverns outside the old Dwarven Forge. On the last trip before the webs got too thick, I saw a seam of purple stone running through the wall behind the lower supports. It was dull until the lamp came close, then it showed a clean violet line under the soot. I don't think it was amethyst. It sat too deep in the rock and had a dry powder on the edges, almost like it had been sweating and then gone cold again.

Method

1. Expose the Grave Moss to bright light until it contracts.
2. Pour Moonwater over it. Keep the cauldron covered.
3. Crush the Nightshade Berries beneath the cover.
4. Add the Bluecap Spores. Breathe across the surface until a blue ring forms.
5. Stir in the Powdered Pearl without lifting the cover.
6. Add the Blessed Hart Antler Powder last.

If the blue ring hangs in the air and pops, and the liquid settles into a dull gray film that reflects faces, something has gone wrong. I wish there were a way to recover the ingredients from a spoiled batch, but so far every attempt has cost more than starting again.

I sometimes leave the kettle on after I've finished work because it's a sound I recognise. The pipes knock and things scrape in the passages, and otherwise I keep stopping to listen. With the kettle going I can usually get through the washing up without checking the door. It uses fuel I ought to save, but I've been doing it anyway.

Potion of Invisibility

It makes the drinker invisible for 1 hour, ending early if they attack, deal damage, or cast a spell. It won't quiet my boots or get me through a locked door, but I'm still keeping a bottle for myself. There may be a day when getting past without being noticed is enough.

For now I need to get through a batch without lifting the cover to see how it's doing. I did that last time, then had to explain to myself why the rim was disappearing. Leave the book open until the work is finished; counting stock can wait.

Ingredients

2 pinches Powdered Pearl

1 measure Moonwater

1 pinch Nightshade Berries

1 tuft Grave Moss

1 pinch Blessed Hart Antler Powder

1 pinch Bluecap Spores

I am sure it could be made useful if I could bring back enough to test. Purple materials can be treacherous in healing work because everyone assumes they belong with Nightshade Berries, and most of them only make the bitterness worse. This stone felt different under the knife point. It left a faint grit on the blade, and the grit held to the metal until I wiped it with vinegar. It may draw a charge the way Thunderhead Lichen does, or it may bind sour reagents before they spoil the mouth of a draught. I would want to try it first with Moonwater and a very small amount of Troll Blood, nowhere near a salable batch.

I did not have the pick or the little hammer with me. I had only gone for polishing grit and a look at the troughs, so I took the lamp, two sacks, and the bad knife I use for scraping. I tried to pry a little loose and only chipped the knife. That was foolish, because I knew better as soon as I started. A proper sample needs a clean break, not a dirty smear from the wall.

Going back for it would mean taking the pick, the hammer, a covered lantern, two sacks, and probably a climbing dose if the lower path is webbed again. It would also mean deciding that a purple seam in the rock is worth walking into a place the spiders have claimed. I can hear how that sounds when I write it out. Good ingredients make men stupid, and I am not as young as I was when stupidity healed overnight.

Still, I keep turning it over. The forge caverns are dangerous, but the stone was close enough to the entrance that I might manage it if I went quietly and did not stop to sort grit at the same time. I would need to clear the webbing from the doorway without burning it, because smoke down there sits in the throat. I would need one sack for the stone and one for the polishing grit, and I would need to leave the metal stock alone no matter how useful it looks. That last part may be the hardest, since the bent stirring rod mocks me every morning.

Method

1. Soak the Grave Moss in Moonwater until the fibers contract.
2. Add the Kingsfoil and crush it against the cauldron wall.
3. Lower the Ironvine Thread into the mixture. Stir until it pulls taut.

The goblin offered Glassroot Sap when I asked for Ironvine Thread, since both pull into long strands. They aren't interchangeable. The sap sets hard in a healing mixture; here I need a thread that stays under tension until the honey goes in. I showed him the difference with a little of each. He still wanted the same price for the sap.

4. Dust in the Blessed Hart Antler Powder.
5. Add the Honey of the Sun Bee in three drops while the thread remains taut.
6. Remove the thread before bottling.

The finished potion crawls up the bottle instead of settling. With the stopper out, it clings in a green ribbon. If it sinks like mud and the Ironvine Thread breaks into loose fibers, the batch has failed.

I thought about using it above the forge doorway to avoid the webs, then remembered what made the webs. There is grit and good metal stock in there, and the bent stirring rod needs replacing, but I am not climbing into a spider-filled forge for either. I asked whether the goblins knew another way in. They told me to leave the forge alone and would not even try to sell me a map, which settled it.

Potion of Climbing

Tried this on the high passage yesterday. It gives a climb speed equal to the drinker's speed for 1 hour, with advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks made to climb. Getting up there was easy enough. The door was still locked when I reached it.

I had to come down with the bottle between my teeth because the pocket I meant to put it in has a hole. I need to mend the coat before I try anything else. It's no good getting out if I leave all my supplies at the bottom of a wall.

Ingredients

1 spoonful Grave Moss

2 sprigs Kingsfoil

1 measure Moonwater

1 pinch Blessed Hart Antler Powder

1 pinch Ironvine Thread

3 drops Honey of the Sun Bee

I might ask Flaxese whether he knows the stone. He will either pretend he has never heard of it or charge me for the privilege of hearing him lie. If he has a porter who has seen the seam, that would still be worth knowing. I should ask as if I am curious about pretty rock for grinding color. If he hears ingredient in my voice, the price will climb before I finish the sentence.

Jumping Potion

Someone asked whether two bottles would get him across the whole chamber. I explained that for 1 hour the potion triples long jump and high jump distances, with advantage on Athletics checks made to jump. He wanted me to promise he'd reach the other side. I couldn't, and I only sold him one bottle.

I hope he listened. I don't mind being asked questions about my work, but I can't measure a gap I haven't seen. Next time I'll ask him to show me before we discuss a price.

Ingredients

3 drops Honey of the Sun Bee

1 measure Moonwater

2 pinches Powdered Pearl

1 pinch Blessed Hart Antler Powder

1 sprig Kingsfoil

1 pinch Thunderhead Lichen

1 seed Echo Seed

Method

1. Shake the Moonwater until blue-white sparks fill it.
2. Tap the Thunderhead Lichen with the glass rod. Catch its tiny spark in the liquid.
3. Add the Powdered Pearl. Stir until silver ribbons rise.
4. Crush in the Kingsfoil.
5. Add the Honey of the Sun Bee in three drops.
6. Roll the Echo Seed around the cauldron once. Let it repeat the last tap.
7. Finish with the Blessed Hart Antler Powder.

The Echo Seed kept repeating the tap after I'd finished, so I wrapped the tin in a rag. There is a spent seed loose on the shelf as well. I need to throw it away before I pick it up for the next batch.

Heard people running in the passage while I was eating. I put the lamp out and waited, but nobody stopped at my door. By the time I was sure they were gone, the soup had cooled and I didn't want much of it.

I couldn't find my boots in the dark because I'd pushed them under the bed. They're beside it now. I know where every jar is on the bench, but apparently I can't be trusted to put my own boots somewhere useful.